

5.3A Staff Screening Process

Control Type: Advisory	Applies to architecture:	A1	A2	A3	A4	B
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<u>Control Definition</u> Control Objective: To the extent permitted and practicable, ensure the trustworthiness of staff operating the user's Swift environment by performing regular staff screening. In-scope components: - All staff (such as employees, agents, consultants, and contractors) with operational (maintenance or administration) access to Swift-related systems, HSMs, Swift and customer (client) connector or middleware servers and on-premises or remote virtualisation or cloud platform hosting Swift-related VMs, including the Alliance Connect Virtual on Premises VPN, Swift and customer (client) connector VMs or middleware server VMs. - All staff with operational access (maintenance or administration) to a customer client connector Risk Drivers: - untrustworthy staff or system operators						
<u>Implementation Guidance</u> Control Statement: Staff operating the user's Swift infrastructure are screened prior to initial appointment in that role and periodically thereafter. Control Context: A staff screening process with internal or external clearance, provides additional assurance that operators or administrators of the user's Swift infrastructure are trustworthy, and reduces the risk of insider threats. Implementation Guidelines: The implementation guidelines are common methods to apply the relevant control. The guidelines are a helpful way to begin an assessment but should never be considered as an audit checklist as each user's implementation may vary. Therefore, in cases where some implementation guidelines elements are not present or partially covered, mitigations as well as particular environment specificities must be considered to properly assess the overall compliance adherence level (as per the suggested guidelines or as per the alternatives). To the extent permitted under applicable laws and regulations³⁷, and considering local practices and available information, the following guidelines and specified verifications are recommended: - All in-scope staff are screened at least every 5 years. - For those already in the role and not yet screened, a catch-up process is gradually organised as part of the periodic screening (sometimes also referred to as re-screening) - The screening process for initial employment includes the following verifications: - Identity verification - Confirmation of full details of qualifications - Confirmation of previous employment history - Details of any past or pending civil or criminal proceedings against the employee - Validation of any involvement in external businesses that could result in a conflict of interest - Financial credit verification - The periodic screening process includes the following verifications:						

³⁷ Including, where applicable, social concertation

- Details of any pending civil or criminal proceedings against the employee
- Validation of any involvement in external businesses that could result in a conflict of interest
- Financial credit verification

Note: in case of staff not directly employed by the Swift user (such as agents, contractors or consultants), the screening can fall under contractual obligation between the Swift user and the employer.